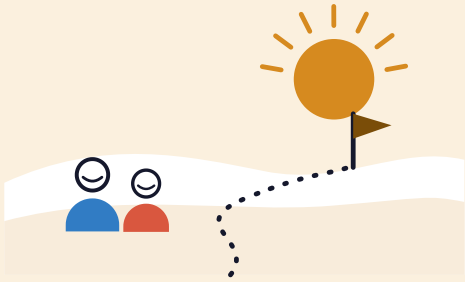
Conversation 1 · Why

Why are we here?

Purpose, beneficiaries and a shared picture of success.



Key questions

1. Who benefits from our work?
2. What difference should the team make for them?
3. What would meaningful success look like?

The exercises

Explain it to a friend

Pairs, then whole team · 25 min

Find plain, human words for why the team exists, before anyone writes a mission statement.

In three years' time…

Individual, then whole team · 30 min

Agree one picture of success that feels true to everyone, and the early signs that it is happening.

Notes from the conversation

Goes on your Team Canvas: **Our purpose · Our future**

Explain it to a friend

Why are we here? · Pairs, then whole team · 25 min

Find plain, human words for why the team exists, before anyone writes a mission statement.

How to run it

1. In pairs, imagine explaining the team's reason for being to a friend over dinner. Speak naturally and avoid organisational language.
2. The listener does not correct or debate. They capture phrases that feel clear, human and meaningful.
3. Switch roles, then compare what was consistent and what was different.
4. Use the strongest language to create a shared purpose statement.

Worksheet

We exist to…

We do this for…

We do this by…



In three years' time...

Why are we here? · Individual, then whole team · 30 min

Agree one picture of success that feels true to everyone, and the early signs that it is happening.

How to run it

1. Each person completes: "In three years' time, this team will have..." Create two or three versions individually.
2. Share without discussion and group similar ideas.
3. Vote for the statement that most unites the team and feels true, not merely the most ambitious.
4. Refine it together and identify two or three signs that would show it is becoming real.

Worksheet

In three years' time, this team will have...

We will know this is becoming real when...